PRACTICE EXAM 19 / EXAM SET 03

Domain 5: Administrative Assisting

12 scored questions	4 answer choices per question	Answer key + explanations included

Instructions

Choose the single best answer (A, B, C, or D) for each question. Mark your responses before checking the answer key and detailed explanations at the end of this document. These practice questions are not official NHA examination items.

QUESTIONS

Q01 | Scheduling and Patient Flow

Which appointment pattern is an example of stream scheduling?

A. Several patients arrive at the beginning of each hour and are seen during that hour.

B. Two patients are assigned the same starting time for one provider.

C. Patients arrive without assigned times and are seen in arrival order.

D. Patients receive individual appointment times spaced at regular intervals.

Q02 | Insurance and Prior Authorization

> **SCENARIO** A patient asks whether a hearing aid purchase is covered because the plan summary lists hearing services as a benefit. The verified detailed benefit response covers diagnostic hearing tests but specifically excludes hearing aid purchases. The patient has not bought the device. Office policy directs disputed benefit questions to the insurance specialist for payer clarification.

Which response accurately uses the available benefit information?

A. Explain that coverage of hearing tests also establishes coverage of hearing aid purchases.

B. Explain the test-versus-device distinction and offer insurance-specialist clarification.

C. Explain that a provider order will override the stated device exclusion.

D. Explain that the device exclusion also removes coverage for diagnostic hearing tests.

Q03 | Coding Billing and Payments

SCENARIO A patient has separate accounts for two dates of service within the same practice. A $45 payment receipt clearly identifies the March 2 visit, but the transaction was posted to the April 6 visit. Office policy allows the billing team to transfer a verified misapplied payment while preserving the original transaction history.

Which request should the assistant send to the billing team?

A. Transfer the existing payment to March 2 using the receipt and preserve the transaction history.
B. Collect another March 2 payment and leave the April 6 posting as it is.
C. Create a second $45 payment entry for March 2 without changing the April 6 posting.
D. Delete the receipt and apply a $45 courtesy adjustment to March 2.

Q04 | Records Office Systems and Supplies

SCENARIO The clinic ordered 12 cartons of office supplies. Eight cartons arrive, and the packing slip lists four cartons as backordered. The invoice nevertheless bills for all 12 cartons. Office policy records only physically received supplies as available stock and routes invoice discrepancies to the purchasing coordinator before payment.

Which receiving action follows the policy?

A. Record 12 cartons as available because the purchase order requested that amount.
B. Record four cartons as available because those are listed as backordered.
C. Record eight cartons as available and flag the four-carton invoice discrepancy.
D. Record eight cartons as available and close the order as fully delivered.

Q05 | Scheduling and Patient Flow

SCENARIO A patient arrives 18 minutes late for a 20-minute routine appointment. The provider has reviewed the situation and directed the front desk to offer rescheduling. Clinic policy states that staff should obtain patient agreement on a new appointment rather than shift subsequent patients or squeeze the visit into the remaining time.

Which scheduling action follows these instructions?

A. Check the patient in for a two-minute visit without consulting the patient.
B. Offer suitable replacement openings and confirm the patient's selected appointment.
C. Move the next patient's appointment later to make room for the late arrival.
D. Record the patient as having completed the visit and leave the original booking unchanged.

Q06 | Records Office Systems and Supplies

SCENARIO The electronic record system becomes unavailable during clinic hours. The office has approved downtime encounter forms and a process for later reconciliation into the restored system. The manager activates that downtime process and asks assistants to continue their authorized documentation tasks.

Which approach follows the office process?

A. Use the approved forms with actual encounter details and times, then reconcile them when the system returns.
B. Wait to document until the system returns and reconstruct encounter details from memory.
C. Create temporary duplicate patient charts in an unrelated application and use those as the permanent records.
D. Enter the same generic note for each affected encounter when the system returns.

Q07 | Insurance and Prior Authorization

SCENARIO A payer authorization allows eight therapy visits. Five have been completed and two additional authorized visits are already scheduled. The provider now requests two more visits beyond those already scheduled. All visits count equally toward this authorization, and office policy requires the referral coordinator to obtain any additional authorization before confirming visits beyond the approved total.

Which authorization-status message should the assistant send to the coordinator?

A. One visit remains uncommitted; one of the two newly requested visits needs additional authorization.
B. Three visits remain uncommitted; both newly requested visits fit within the current authorization.
C. Two visits remain uncommitted; both newly requested visits fit within the current authorization.
D. No visits remain uncommitted; both newly requested visits need additional authorization.

Q08 | Coding Billing and Payments

SCENARIO On October 8, 2026, an assistant is helping prepare a claim for an outpatient encounter that occurred on September 28, 2026. The office coding reference states that ICD-10-CM selection must use the version effective on the encounter date. The search software currently defaults to a new version effective October 1, 2026.

Which reference should the assistant use to check the documented diagnosis code?

A. The version effective on the date the claim is being prepared.
B. The version effective when the patient first joined the practice.
C. The version effective when the insurance policy was first issued.
D. The version effective for the September 28, 2026 encounter date.

Q09 | Scheduling and Patient Flow

> **SCENARIO** A patient completed all required front-desk check-in steps and has been waiting in the lobby. The rooming dashboard still shows the appointment as "scheduled," and the rooming team sees no arrived patients. Office workflow requires the front desk to change a fully checked-in appointment to "arrived" so it enters the rooming queue.

Which action addresses this patient-flow problem?

A. Mark the encounter as completed so the rooming team can open it.
B. Create a second appointment to make a new entry appear in the queue.
C. Confirm check-in completion, update the status to arrived, and notify the rooming team.
D. Leave the status unchanged because the appointment time is already recorded.

Q10 | Coding Billing and Payments

> **SCENARIO** At checkout, a patient tries to pay the amount due by card. The terminal displays "Declined," and the transaction history shows no authorized or settled payment. The office policy requires an unsuccessful attempt to remain unpaid and allows another approved payment method or referral to the billing desk for payment arrangements.

How should the assistant process the attempted payment?

A. Issue a paid receipt because the patient presented a card.
B. Record the unsuccessful attempt and offer an approved payment alternative or billing-desk help.
C. Post a completed payment because an amount was entered into the terminal.
D. Remove the amount due from the account because the terminal could not collect it.

Q11 | Records Office Systems and Supplies

> **SCENARIO** An assistant needs a paper chart for an upcoming visit. The chart is absent from its assigned shelf, where an outguide lists the same medical record number, the checkout date, and the staff member who borrowed it. Office policy uses outguides to track charts temporarily removed from filing.

What should the assistant do to locate the chart?

A. Open a new permanent chart because the original folder is absent.
B. Remove the outguide and wait for someone to return the folder.
C. Search unrelated patient folders without checking the recorded borrower.
D. Use the outguide information to contact the borrower and arrange chart retrieval.

Q12 | Insurance and Prior Authorization

Which payment maintains health insurance coverage and remains separate from the out-of-pocket limit for covered in-network care?

A. The monthly insurance premium.
B. A deductible payment for a covered in-network service.
C. A copayment for a covered in-network office visit.
D. Coinsurance for a covered in-network procedure.

ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATIONS

Practice Exam 19 | Domain 5: Administrative Assisting | 12 scored questions

01 D	02 B	03 A	04 C	05 B	06 A
07 A	08 D	09 C	10 B	11 D	12 A

DETAILED EXPLANATIONS

Q01 | Correct answer: D

Patients receive individual appointment times spaced at regular intervals.

Stream scheduling assigns individual appointment times at regular intervals. Wave scheduling brings a group of patients at a shared time, while double booking assigns the same time to more than one patient. An open-hours system does not assign individual appointment times.

Q02 | Correct answer: B

Explain the test-versus-device distinction and offer insurance-specialist clarification.

The detailed response distinguishes diagnostic testing from device purchases, so the broad summary cannot be used to promise coverage for the device. The assistant can explain that distinction and offer the stated clarification process. A provider order does not itself override the supplied benefit exclusion.

Q03 | Correct answer: A

Transfer the existing payment to March 2 using the receipt and preserve the transaction history.

The receipt establishes which encounter the existing payment belongs to, and the stated transfer process corrects its allocation without inventing a new payment. The assistant should supply that evidence to the billing team. Posting another payment would falsely record additional money received and leave the original allocation error unresolved.

Q04 | Correct answer: C

Record eight cartons as available and flag the four-carton invoice discrepancy.

Only eight cartons are physically available, and 12 billed minus 8 received leaves a four-carton discrepancy for purchasing review. The backordered cartons remain outstanding rather than available inventory. Closing the order as complete would also lose track of the undelivered supplies.

Q05 | Correct answer: B

Offer suitable replacement openings and confirm the patient's selected appointment.

The provider has already made the disposition decision, and the assistant should carry out the specified rescheduling process with the patient. Confirming a selected replacement opening creates an accurate schedule. Changing later patients' appointments or recording a completed visit would not follow the instructions or the actual events.

Q06 | Correct answer: A

Use the approved forms with actual encounter details and times, then reconcile them when the system returns.

The approved downtime forms support contemporaneous documentation while the normal system is unavailable. Reconciliation after restoration connects that documentation to the appropriate electronic records under office policy. Delayed reconstruction from memory increases omissions, while duplicate charts or generic notes do not accurately preserve individual encounters.

Q07 | Correct answer: A

One visit remains uncommitted; one of the two newly requested visits needs additional authorization.

Eight authorized minus five completed minus two already scheduled leaves one uncommitted visit. The two newly requested visits therefore exceed the remaining authorization by one. Counting only completed visits would overlook the two approved visits already reserved on the schedule.

Q08 | Correct answer: D

The version effective for the September 28, 2026 encounter date.

For this outpatient encounter, the assistant should use the ICD-10-CM version effective on the date of service, September 28. The supplied reference explicitly states this rule. A software default for the preparation date does not replace the version applicable to the encounter being billed.

Q09 | Correct answer: C

Confirm check-in completion, update the status to arrived, and notify the rooming team.

The missing arrived status prevents the appointment from entering the stated rooming workflow. After confirming that check-in is complete, the assistant should correct the status and notify the team. A duplicate appointment or a completed status would create additional inaccuracies rather than reflect the patient's actual stage of the visit.

Q10 | Correct answer: B

Record the unsuccessful attempt and offer an approved payment alternative or billing-desk help.

The terminal and transaction history establish that no payment was authorized or settled, so the attempt should not be posted as a completed payment. The assistant should use the permitted alternatives and document the actual outcome. Presenting a card or entering an amount does not establish that funds were received.

Q11 | Correct answer: D

Use the outguide information to contact the borrower and arrange chart retrieval.

The outguide identifies where to start tracking the temporarily removed chart. Contacting the listed borrower follows that record and helps retrieve the existing folder. Creating a new permanent chart would fragment the record, and discarding the outguide would remove the location information.

Q12 | Correct answer: A

The monthly insurance premium.

The premium is the payment for maintaining insurance coverage and is not included in the out-of-pocket limit. Deductibles, copayments, and coinsurance are forms of cost sharing for care and may count toward the applicable limit under the plan. Premiums remain a separate cost even when the care-related limit is reached.

End of Practice Exam